Hope Hospitals Creation Date 01/01/2017 Released Date 11/01/2017 Reviewed On :- 16/01/2023 Reviewed On :- 15/01/2025	**Written Guidance on Patient Monitoring After Medication Administration**	
	Version: 1.0	
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1. Purpose

To ensure systematic monitoring of patients after medication administration to detect and manage adverse effects, allergic reactions, therapeutic response, and to promote patient safety.

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2. Scope

This guidance applies to all nursing staff, physicians, and healthcare professionals involved in patient care across inpatient, outpatient, emergency, and critical care areas.

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3. Objectives

- Detect adverse drug reactions (ADRs) and side effects early
- Assess and document patient's clinical response to medications
- Ensure patient safety, especially with high-risk drugs
- Comply with NABH medication safety and clinical monitoring standards

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4. Key Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Registered Nurse	Monitor and document vital signs, reactions, and patient complaints post-medication
Physician	Review therapeutic response and modify treatment as needed
Pharmacist	Provide information on drug-specific monitoring requirements
ICU/ER Staff	Continuously monitor patients receiving emergency or high-risk medications

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5. General Monitoring Guidelines

A. Immediately After Administration

- Confirm patient identity and drug details before administration (as per the **"7 Rights"** of medication administration).
- Monitor the patient for **15–30 minutes** after administration of:
  - First-time medications
  - Antibiotics
  - Blood products
  - High-alert drugs (e.g., insulin, opioids, chemotherapy, anticoagulants)
  - IV bolus or infusion medications

B. Routine Monitoring Parameters

- **Vital signs:** BP, HR, RR, SpO_2, Temperature
- **Consciousness level and pain score (where applicable)**
- **Allergic reactions:** Rash, itching, swelling, respiratory distress
- **Side effects:** Nausea, dizziness, sedation, etc.
- **Therapeutic response:** Symptom relief, lab value improvement, etc.

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6. Drug-Specific Monitoring Examples

Drug Class	Monitoring Requirement
Antihypertensives	BP, HR before and after
Insulin / Antidiabetics	Blood glucose levels before and 1–2 hrs after
Opioids / Sedatives	RR, consciousness level, sedation score
Anticoagulants (e.g., Heparin, Warfarin)	Bleeding signs, PT/INR/aPTT
Antibiotics (IV)	Allergic reaction, temperature, WBC trend
Chemotherapy	CBC, nausea/vomiting, mucositis, fatigue, renal/liver function

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7. Documentation

- Record all observations in the **Medication Administration Record (MAR)** and **Nursing Notes**.
- Include:
  - Date and time of administration
  - Vital signs pre/post (where applicable)
  - Observed side effects or adverse reactions
  - Action taken, if any (e.g., drug withheld, physician informed)

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8. Escalation Protocol

- Report immediately to the physician if:
  - Any abnormal reaction or vital sign change occurs
  - The patient shows no therapeutic response as expected
  - The patient complains of new symptoms post-medication
- Follow institutional **Code Blue** or **emergency escalation** protocols for serious reactions (e.g., anaphylaxis).